

The most important thing I had to purchase was the printer that was to be used for desktop use – no photos, just everyday prints – some documents, a few images here and there, that kind of thing. The budget was also pretty low. I had



Canon iP1980

to find something under Rs. 4,000. There were very few options available. Printers are difficult products to sell and the requirements of people are simple – it should print and it should be cheap. That's exactly what has happened. Printers have been made so cheap that they are even cheaper than the cartridges at times. Some people actually think of purchasing a new printer every time one starts breaking down.

There isn't a lot of choice in printers. Shop keepers tend to stock a couple of models of each brand. Asking for specific models often proves fruitless. Such was the case when I asked for a few models from Canon. Still, I only found the Canon Pixma iP1980 easily. The price is around Rs. 2,000. There was also a cheap HP printer – the Deskjet D2668 is priced at Rs. 2,300. In term of specifications and numbers, they were pretty identical. I made a few enquiries to check for any Epson printers. I could only find a model called C58. The price was Rs. 1,750.

I had no luck finding laser printers under Rs. 5,000 either. I thought prices would've dropped. The cheapest laser monochrome printer around, the Canon Laser Shot LBP3108B, is available for Rs. 5,500. Samsung, too, entered this price range. Their ML-2245I model was able to get the price down to around Rs. 6,600. HP's Laserjet P1007 was also available at around the same price. This was a product we had tested in the past and we know it to be a reliable mono laser printer.

I've seen people going in for more compact photo printers that are used to print photos to paper directly from a digital camera. Canon's Selphy printers are perfect for that kind of use. The Canon Selphy CP760 is the cheapest option around at just Rs. 5,600. The CP770 model is some Rs. 9,200. For those who are